

San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Newsletter

November 2025

Creator Lorna Stafford

Last Chance To Get You Tickets!!



🍷 **SFA Christmas Party** 📅 Save the Date! 🗓️ **Thursday 11th**

December 📍 Venue: The Unicorn Marden. Pull on your festive knits and join us for a night of laughter, mulled wine, and merriment. Expect crackling conversations, seasonal nibbles, and maybe a cheeky singalong. 🎁 Cosy vibes 🌲 Good company 🍷 Pub cheer. and a **FREE RAFFLE!!** Let's toast to friendship and the year we've shared. See you there! [HERE FOR TICKETS](#)

SFA RACING RETURNS-BE PART OF THE LEGACY

SFA RACING IS BACK!



The Return of Speed, Grit & Purple Power!

For years, members have asked: ***"When will San Fairy Ann get back into racing?"***

Well, dust off your legs and tighten your helmets, because **2026 is the year we put SFA back where it belongs: on the podium and on the racing map of the South-East.**

Our Mission

To build a strong, visible, competitive SFA Racing squad, a team that rides together, pushes each other, and proudly represents the club at key regional events. This isn't just racing for racing's sake. It's about rebuilding a legacy, reigniting ambition, and making the SFA name impossible to ignore.

2026 Focus: Two Disciplines, One Goal

Following consultation with members, the club will concentrate on **two core race formats:**

🚩 **Road Racing Series**

Time Trials

Other forms of racing (track, cyclocross, etc.) aren't off the table, but these will be our flagship disciplines for 2026.

For 2026, SFA will cover **race entry fees** for members who take part in the race programme and help promote the club's racing comeback. **No excuses. No barriers. Just opportunity.**

Road Racing Series, The Big One

We're targeting events at **Cyclopark**, and we're not turning up to make up the numbers.

The club will support a **five-rider SFA Racing Team**, and here's the game-changer:

For selected team members, the club will fund:

- ✓ An official **SFA Racing skinsuit**
- ✓ Entry fees
- ✓ Reasonable travel costs

All we ask in return is a commitment to race for the club at our nominated events and help re-establish our racing reputation.

Want In?

If you're not ready for the full team commitment but fancy dipping a toe into competitive cycling, great news:

Furthermore, we will be looking for Pitt Groupies, to help and support our racers!

For 2026, SFA will cover race entry fees for members who take part in the programme and help promote the club's racing comeback. No excuses. No barriers. Just opportunity.

This Is More Than Racing

It's about:

- bringing the SFA name back to the front of the pack
- building a team that trains, learns and pushes limits together
- showing the South-East that **San Fairy Ann is not done yet**

The heritage is there. The riders are here.

Now it's time to race again.

Big Shoes to Fill, Can You Help?

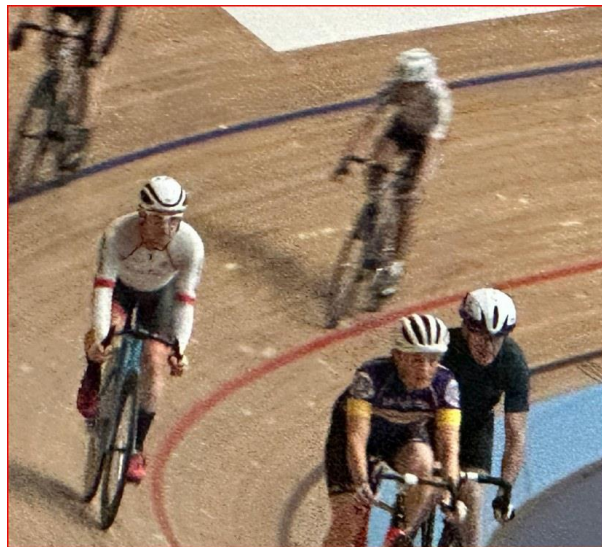


Do You Remember this Plea from the Last Newsletter?

Well I bring GREAT news, our very own Mike Lambourne has kindly offered to reignite the **Easy Rider group** and we are absolutely thrilled! Mike has been with the Club since 2012, so fully equipped to take this challenge forward. It's a small group now admittedly but we know that people have been asking to join a slower paced group, of shorter distances. So please lets all get behind making this group a huge success, and if you know anyone contemplating returning to cycling, let Mike know and give him a call on **07949 184250** and they will **NEVER RIDE ALONE!**

🔥 AUTUMN 2026 TRACK EVENT, THE DAY WE TURNED INTO
ROCKETS 🔥









Why on earth wouldn't you go on one of Barbara's legendary track days? Seriously, if you missed it, you may need to sit down, because what happened at the velodrome was nothing short of sensational.

First of all, you're not just riding a bike...

You're riding on the iconic Olympic Velodrome — the very boards where world champions have flown. The moment you roll down that ramp, you feel it: this is not your average Sunday pootle to a café. This is speed, adrenaline and goosebumps wrapped in smooth Siberian timber.

The bikes are different. The track is different. The whole experience is different, and that's exactly why it's so electrifying. No brakes. One gear. A banking so steep you wonder if it's legal. Yet somehow, within minutes, everyone was whizzing around it like human missiles.

And forget about British weather ruining your fun!

The Velodrome is warm, dry, and primed for take-off.

Even better, you are guided by professional coaches **and** our very own track royalty, Barbara and Geoff, who seem to have been born pedalling at 45 degrees. Their support turns nerves into confidence and quivering legs into turbo engines.

For returning riders, it's like slipping back into a superpower you forgot you had.

For first-timers, the transformation was incredible: wide eyes became wild grins, hesitation became hunger for more, and by the end, everyone was chasing the black line like seasoned pros. The fear didn't stand a chance.

And here's where it gets even more exciting...

 **2026: TWO TRACK DAYS ARE ON THE CARDS**

Barbara is considering doubling the fun next year. Imagine:

- more members flying around the boards
- more skills sharpened
- more fitness gained

- and maybe... just maybe... **our own club races**

Oh, and did we mention there's a club track bike up for grabs? Yes, donated, ready, waiting. If you've ever dreamed of track glory, that might be your starting gun.

If you weren't there, you missed something extraordinary.

If you were there, you're already itching to go again.

2026 is your chance. Don't watch from the sidelines, ride the boards, feel the G-force, and become part of something unforgettable.

SFACC 2026 EARLY BIRD ENTRY ON SALE NOW!

The SFA Sportive is back!



Mark your calendars for **Sunday 24th May 2026** - you won't want to miss this one.

After last year's incredible success, we're turning things up a notch with an even bigger and better event. This time we're offering **three fantastic routes**, including a shorter option perfect for newcomers or anyone keen to dip their toe into the world of sportives without the pressure.

Early Bird entry is now open — grab a bargain while you can! Simply head to [Sportive.com](https://www.sportive.com), search **SFACC Sportive**, and secure your place.

Get ready for a brilliant day out on the bike. The countdown starts now! 🚴

AGM UPDATE



When the AGM voting paperwork went out, members had the option to leave anonymous comments. One member asked:

“Why are these the only people we can vote for? Why isn’t there an opportunity to vote for others?”

It’s an excellent question, thank you for asking it.

Each June, our Chairman, Duncan Edwards, invites **all Club Members** (via email and this newsletter) to put themselves forward to join the Board. Every position is open to any member who wishes to stand. Unfortunately, year after year, **no one volunteers**.

That means the current Board members continue in their roles simply because there are **no alternative candidates**. Several of us would genuinely welcome stepping down or sharing responsibilities, but without new volunteers, the workload can't be spread, and the club risks becoming overstretched.

So, the reason the ballot looks the same each year isn’t because we don’t want change, it’s because **no one else has stepped forward**.

If you want different names on the ballot, we would love nothing more than to see them. Fresh ideas, new energy, and broader representation would be fantastic for the club.

When June 2026 comes around, please seriously consider putting your name forward.

Even a small amount of time can make a big difference, and you’d be helping to secure the club’s future.

We've Had a Few Changes



We've had a little shuffle on the team, and you'll spot a few new faces in key roles.

Philip Thorpe has stepped down as **Director of Club Runs**, and we're delighted to announce that Emma Tuffey will be taking the role on. Emma will be taking this opportunity to meet-up with all the Ride Co-ordinators in due course. She's looking forward to this new challenge. This means Emma's previous role becomes vacant, and we're pleased to welcome **Veronica Harmer** as our new **Club Secretary**. Welcome aboard, Veronica!

A quick reminder too that **Tony Palmer** is now leading on **Club Training & Safety**.

Both Tony and Emma are keen to get out and ride with all the groups, so you'll no doubt see them out on the road very soon.

Ladies Cycling Holidays in the UK



Cycling Holidays - Lake District

Join us for an unforgettable 3 day cycling adventure in the majestic [Lake District](#). Fully guided rides for women, distances of 30 - 40 miles a day. Cycling has long been a popular way to explore the majestic lakes and mountains of Lakeland. On this guided cycling weekend you will visit charming villages and enjoy breathtaking panoramic views. Our experienced guides

will lead you on stunning routes, tailored to your skill level. From our base near [Coniston](#) you'll explore popular destinations like Ambleside, Grasmere, [Windermere](#) and experience the more remote less-visited spots and untouched lakes. If you have never experienced the lakes by bike, join us on this adventure, because two wheels are the best way to explore! For more information contact: [Sea Fern Adventure Retreats:](#)

Travels in Warwickshire





My latest cycling adventure began with a white, knuckle ride from Victoria to Marylebone, dodging buses, taxis and pedestrians who clearly hadn't read the Highway Code. From there I escaped London on a train to Leamington Spa and headed straight for Warwick Castle in search of my first British Cycle Quest clue, only to realise I was looking at the *wrong gate*. Still, Warwick's old town made for a charming detour.

With the clue solved and food supplies replenished, I continued towards Lighthorne, stopping to admire a remarkable stone windmill built in 1632. As evening approached and campsites failed to materialise, I found myself bivouacked between gravestones in the village churchyard with the blessing of "Nick the Bonfire Man", a first for me, and surprisingly comfortable.

The next morning began with an eye, wateringly expensive but excellent breakfast at the cricket pavilion café before I made for the Heritage Motor Museum. After browsing classic cars and overheating gently, I returned to my churchyard campsite, where yet another local reassured me that my presence among the tombstones was perfectly acceptable, apparently the church has everything *except* a congregation.

The following day's clue was at Anne Hathaway's Cottage near Stratford-upon-Avon. En route I detoured through Charlecote Park for a National Trust lunch (never disappointing)

and a fascinating look at their historic kitchens and coaches. Later, after chatting with a Romany caravan owner about horses, heritage, and everything in between, I followed the canal out of Stratford and slept beside a village playing field.

My final day took me through Alcester, a delightful town untouched by chain stores, before meeting friends at a minimalist but perfectly sociable campsite. We spent the weekend exploring, eating, and rescuing tents from free, range chickens. Fortunately no-one found any eggs in their sleeping bags. before I finally pedalled back to the station and homeward.

A few clues collected, a few characters met, and one more patch of Britain explored, all in true wandering, cyclist style.

by **Michael Griffiths**

CALL TO ACTION — WE NEED YOU!

The Board isn't a closed shop.

It's simply waiting for people like you to step forward.

If you want fresh faces, new ideas, and shared responsibilities, then **be part of the change**. Next June, put your name forward and help shape the future of the club you care about.

No experience needed. Just enthusiasm, commitment, and a willingness to help.

 **Interested? Curious? Want to know more?**

Email chairman@sanfairynn.co.uk or speak to any current Board member.

Don't wait for someone else to do it.

Next year, that name on the ballot could be yours.

Welcome New Fairies

Mike Coward

Veronica Harmer

"Welcome to the club! We're thrilled to have you join our community. Here's to great rides, new friendships, and plenty of adventures ahead!"

Club Contacts

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Emma Tuffey Ride Director Of Club Runs & Events - 07976 262260

Veronica Harmer - Club Secretary - 07910 265061

Tony Palmer - Training & Safety - 07786 393838